

Team Worksheet — Lab 30

Financial Benefits Validation, Handover and Project Closure

Team members: _____

Date: _____

1. Our understanding of the problem

2. Our working

Use the data in `lab-30-benefit-validation.xlsx`.

3. What we produced

Deliverable: A Finance-validated benefits statement and a signed handover and closure pack.

4. What the evidence does NOT tell us

5. Our conclusion

6. Step notes

Step 1. Learn the benefit categories precisely. HARD: cost reduction that appears in the P&L. SOFT: capacity or time released without a headcount or cost change. COST AVOIDANCE: costs not incurred that would have been.

Step 2. Understand why the distinction matters: Finance books these differently, and claiming soft benefits as hard is the fastest way to lose credibility with a CFO.

Step 3. Quantify your capstone's benefit against the Lab 3 baseline, using post-improvement data over a defensible period, not a single good week.

Step 4. Verify the improvement is statistically significant, not a favourable run — apply a hypothesis test comparing post-improvement against baseline.

Step 5. Confirm sustained performance with your control chart: the shift must hold for a meaningful period before the benefit can be booked.

Step 6. Separate your benefit into hard, soft and cost-avoidance components and state each explicitly.

Step 7. Take the calculation to Finance and obtain sign-off. Expect challenge on the baseline period, the attribution and whether other changes could explain the result.

Step 8. Prepare your attribution argument: what else changed in the period, and why the improvement is attributable to your intervention rather than to those.

Step 9. Build the handover pack: control plan, updated SOPs, training records, control charts, reaction plans and the named process owner.

Step 10. Conduct the handover meeting with the process owner. They must accept ownership explicitly — an assumed handover is a failed handover.

Step 11. Schedule the sustainability audit at 30, 60 and 90 days post-handover, with a named auditor and defined criteria.

Step 12. Run the lessons learned session: what worked, what did not, what you would do differently, and what transfers to the Green Belts you mentor.

Step 13. Formally close the project with sponsor sign-off, and archive the full DMAIC storyboard.

Step 14. Update the project portfolio from Lab 2 — record the closed project's realised benefit and select the next project.

7. Self-check

Your benefit is separated into hard, soft and cost-avoidance components, validated statistically and signed off by Finance, and the process owner has explicitly accepted handover with a scheduled sustainability audit.

Complete? ☐ Yes ☐ Not yet

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